

Both income deductions and additions to the gross salary should be analyzed carefully to understand where your money is being directed. As you have seen, the bottom line of what you actually receive is not always as clear-cut as what you might have initially thought.

Words of Wisdom

Regardless of your chosen field, your earning power is probably your most valuable asset. Many people will earn more than \$1 million during their working years. Follow the advice in this chapter to maximize your earning potential by:

- Continuing your education.
- Choosing a job that matches your skills and interests.
- Conducting detailed research on various job possibilities.
- Following a career action plan.
- Choosing a career path that is in demand.
- Factoring taxation into your financial plan.
- Comparing fringe benefits from different jobs.

